09-19 第2篇

阅读理解（议论文） Should Middle Schools Require Every Student to Learn to Swim?

① Every summer, Chinese newspapers carry the same sad kind of news: **children drowning in rivers, ponds or small reservoirs** near their homes. According to the Ministry of Education, drowning is one of the leading causes of **accidental death** for students aged 10 to 15. Some cities have already started a new policy: from this year, every middle-school student must take part in a **basic swimming course** and pass a simple swimming test before graduating. But should this become a **national rule** for all middle schools? The question deserves a careful debate.

② Those in favour put **safety** first. Swimming is **not mainly a sport** — it is a **life-saving skill**. A student who can stay afloat for three minutes has a much greater chance of surviving if he falls into deep water while helping at home or playing near a river. In countries where swimming lessons are **required**, such as the Netherlands and parts of Australia, child drowning rates are much lower than in countries where swimming is optional. Supporters argue that if we already require children to learn how to cross a road safely or use fire carefully, **why not teach them how to stay alive in water**, which in many parts of China is just as common?

③ A second reason is **health**. Swimming is one of the few sports that uses **almost every muscle in the body** at the same time, without putting too much pressure on the knees. Doctors note that teenagers who swim regularly have **stronger lungs, straighter backs, and better sleep**. In an age when many students spend hours each day bent over a desk or a phone, a few swimming lessons each month can be a gentle way to protect their growing bodies.

④ However, those against a **national rule** raise real difficulties. First, the **resources** are unequal. A big city school may have its own indoor pool, but a rural middle school may be **two hours away** from the nearest safe pool. Requiring every school to build a pool would be **extremely expensive**, and the money, critics say, might be better spent on basic classrooms, clean drinking water or well-trained teachers. Second, not every student is physically suited to swimming; some have **ear infections, skin problems, or serious asthma**, and a rigid "everyone must pass" rule could cause new kinds of stress.

⑤ There is also the **cost of teachers**. A good swimming class needs **one qualified instructor for every eight students**, with a lifeguard on duty. Training enough teachers of this standard cannot be done in a single year. Rushing the policy, critics warn, may even make swimming class **more dangerous than not having it**, since a poorly supervised class around deep water is a serious risk.

⑥ My own view is that swimming **should be a strongly supported skill**, but the way the rule is written matters a great deal. Rather than a single strict national law, I would suggest a **step-by-step plan**. Schools with nearby pools should start **free swimming classes now**, and the government should help country schools by sending **mobile pools** (temporary pools that can be set up on the playground for two weeks) each summer. Students with medical reasons should be given a safe **water-safety theory course** instead, so nobody is punished for a condition they did not choose.

⑦ Finally, **parents and students** have a part to play. If your school does not yet offer swimming classes, the summer holiday is still a good time to visit a local pool with parents. Ask a qualified coach — not a friend — to teach the **basic safety skills** first: how to float, how to breathe, how to call for help. A single weekend of proper lessons may, one day, be the difference between a happy summer memory and a serious accident.

⑧ A school cannot protect a child every hour of every day. But by teaching children how to **survive near water**, a school gives them a small, life-long gift. That is why, with care and fairness in the details, I believe swimming should slowly become one of the skills every Chinese middle-school student carries into adulthood — **not as a medal to win**, but as a **quiet kind of safety** to take with them for life.

注释： drowning 溺水；stay afloat 漂浮不沉；instructor 教练；asthma 哮喘；mobile pool 移动泳池

根据文章内容，选择最佳答案。

1. Why does the writer open the essay with news about summer drownings (Paragraph 1)?

A. To show that swimming pools are dangerous and should be closed.
B. To introduce the topic — drowning is a leading cause of accidental death for students aged 10–15, and some cities already require middle-school swim lessons; should this become a national rule?
C. To argue that rivers are always safe for children to play in.
D. To announce that the Ministry of Education has banned swimming.

2. According to Paragraph 2, what is the FIRST reason for REQUIRING swimming lessons?

A. Swimming makes students better runners.
B. Swimming is mainly a fun summer sport for the rich.
C. Swimming is a life-saving skill — in countries where lessons are required, child drowning rates are much lower.
D. Swimming is cheaper than any other sport.

3. Which is NOT a difficulty raised by those AGAINST a national rule (Paragraphs 4–5)?

A. Resources are unequal — some rural schools are two hours away from a safe pool; building pools is extremely expensive.
B. Some students have medical problems like ear infections, skin conditions or serious asthma.
C. A good class needs one qualified instructor per eight students, and enough trained teachers cannot be produced in a single year.
D. Swimming classes reduce class time for English and maths.

4. What is the writer's own suggestion (Paragraph 6)?

A. A single strict national law for all schools to follow immediately.
B. Cancel swimming classes completely until the year 2050.
C. A step-by-step plan: schools with pools start classes now; the government sends mobile pools to country schools each summer; students with medical reasons take a water-safety theory course.
D. Parents should not be involved at all.

5. What is the writer's final message in Paragraph 8?

A. Schools should protect every child every minute of every day.
B. A school cannot watch a child every hour, but by teaching survival in water it gives a small life-long gift; swimming should become a quiet kind of safety, not a medal to win.
C. All Chinese students should become Olympic swimmers.
D. Swimming is pointless because accidents can always happen anyway.

答案与解析

1.
【答案】B
【题型】段落主旨题
【定位】第①段 "drowning ... leading cause ... should this become a national rule?"
【解析】首段由溺水新闻引出议题。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

2.
【答案】C
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第②段 "not mainly a sport — it is a life-saving skill ... child drowning rates are much lower"
【解析】支持方首要理由为救生技能及国际经验。A、B、D 均错。故选 C。

3.
【答案】D

【题型】细节判断题
【定位】第④⑤段列举三大反对理由
【解析】文中未提及"挤占英数课时"。A、B、C 均为文章列出。故选 D。

4.
【答案】C
【题型】作者观点题
【定位】第⑥段 "step-by-step plan ... mobile pools ... water-safety theory course"
【解析】作者主张分步推行并兼顾各方。A、B、D 均不符。故选 C。

5.
【答案】B
【题型】主旨/观点题
【定位】第⑧段 "cannot protect a child every hour ... quiet kind of safety ... not a medal to win"
【解析】末段升华：游泳是终身安全而非奖牌。A、C、D 均偏离。故选 B。